

Almost 25% of Ireland's electricity is used by data centers, and it has contributed to the 2nd highest priced electricity in the world. Will supporting AI's electricity needs do the same in other countries?

Posted by u/lughnasadh • 0 points • 77 comments

Data centers aren't the sole cause of Ireland's high electricity prices, but they do contribute to them. The biggest cause is Ireland's reliance on imported natural gas.

That said, data centers are heading for 30% of the country's electricity use, and they contribute significantly to high prices. Effectively a subsidy from Irish consumers to Big Tech. There are other externalized costs, too. E.g. Supporting Big Tech data center infrastructure is delaying house building. Ireland is lucky in that most of Big Tech pays its European taxes to the Irish government, so there's a quid pro quo here. But that is less true for other parts of the world.

Some people think AI may need as big a share of other countries' electricity - who should be paying for this?

[Government warned of rising household bills as data centres strain grid]

(<https://porter.ie/2025/08/22/government-warned-of-rising-household-bills-as-data-centres-strain-grid/>)

Comments

u/avatarname • 1 points • 2025-09-23 10:40 UTC

Ireland is a country where everything is expensive as it is a high GDP country... I do not think it has much to do with data centers as such, more like the business model Ireland has and that they rely on natural gas a lot. If you subsidize electricity to data centers from private customer wallet/prices then yes, it will be the outcome. But you can choose not to.

u/torpedospurs • 1 points • 2025-09-16 00:00 UTC

Why is Ireland dependent on imported natural gas? Does it have poor renewables potential the way Singapore is? The latter did a moratorium on data center construction for a few years due to concerns

over electricity use.

u/Willy_K • 1 points • 2025-09-15 13:14 UTC

It is a reason that Apple, Microsoft, Meta, Amazon and Alphabet all invest in energy production and nuclear. Datacentres and AI will use an ungodly amount of power.